



Individual Teaching Assistant Report Fall 2023 for UGS 303 - WEALTH AND WELL-BEING (64285, 64260, 64265, 64270, 64275, 64280) (Suryansh Upmanyu)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Fall 2023**

Courses Audience: **101**

Responses Received: **48**

Response Ratio: **47.5%**

Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

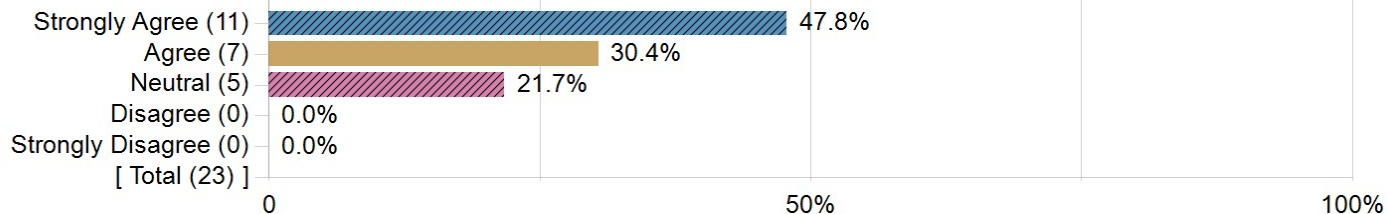
The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

Creation Date: **Tuesday, December 19, 2023**

Teaching Assistant Questions

The TA was available to help me as needed.



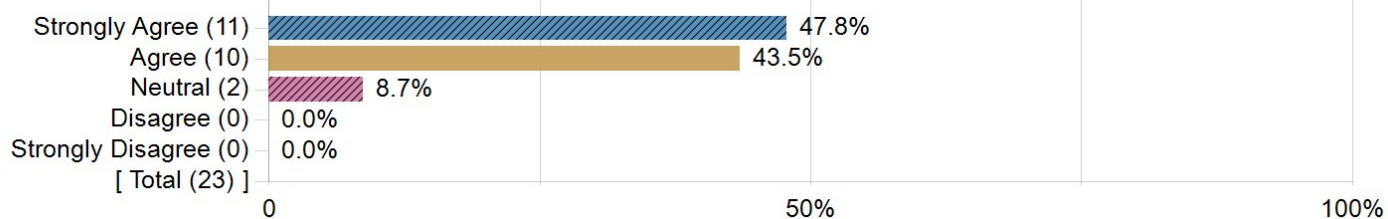
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.26

I felt the TA was approachable.



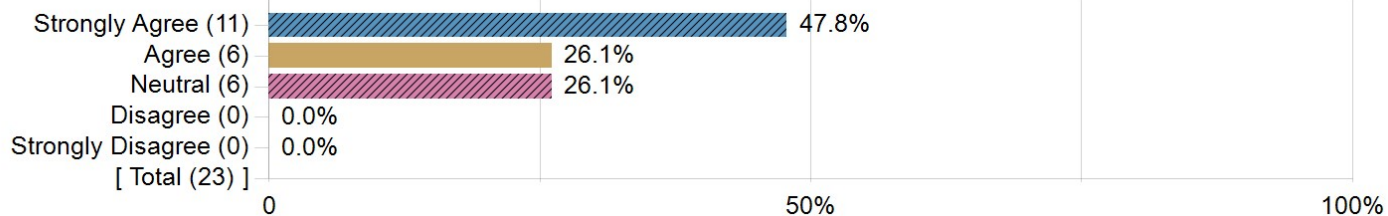
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.39

The TA explained course concepts, subject matter, or other course-related topics in a way that helped me learn.



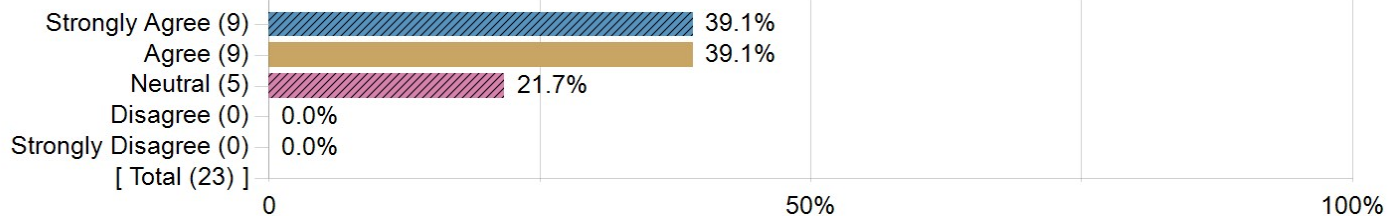
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.22

The TA was able to address most of my questions related to the course concepts, subject -matter, or topics.

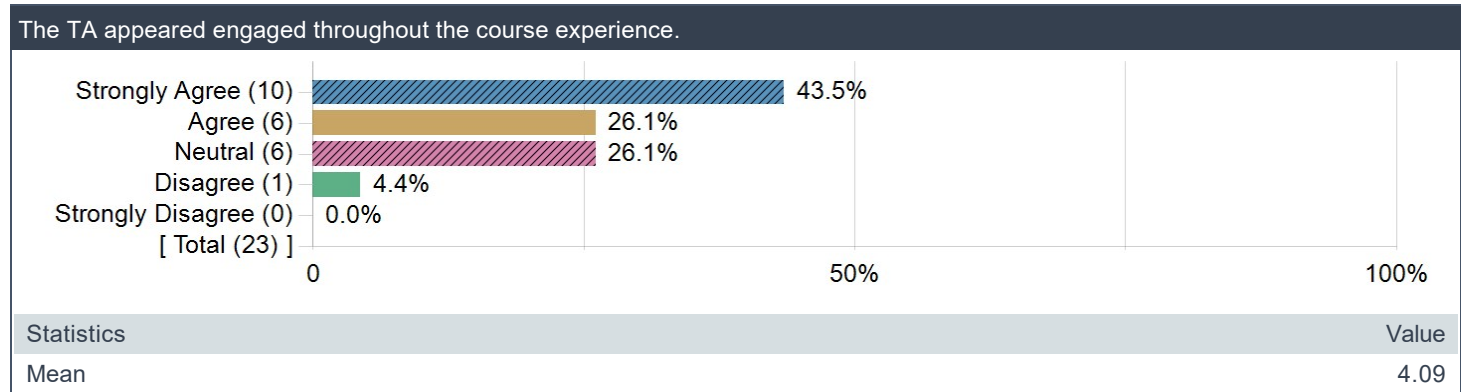
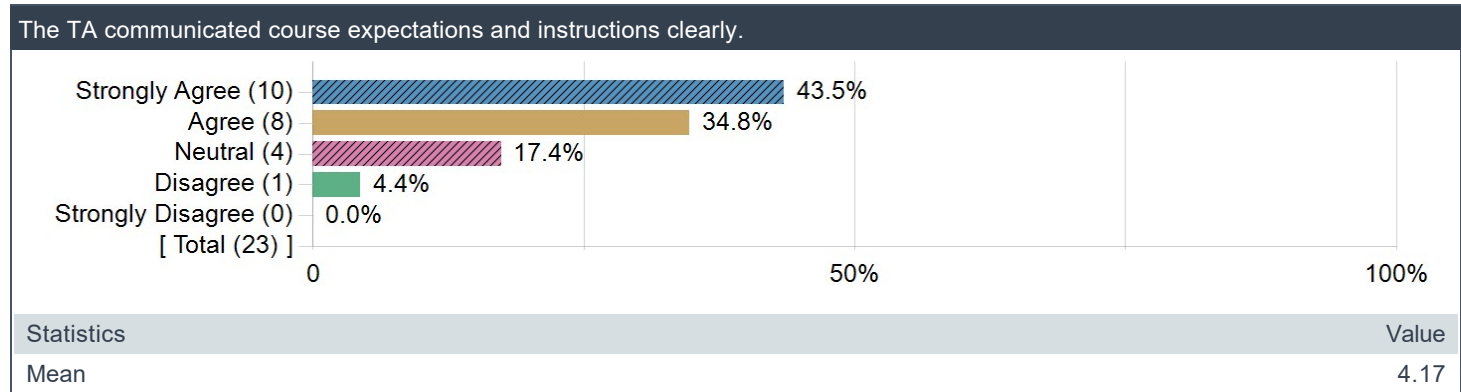
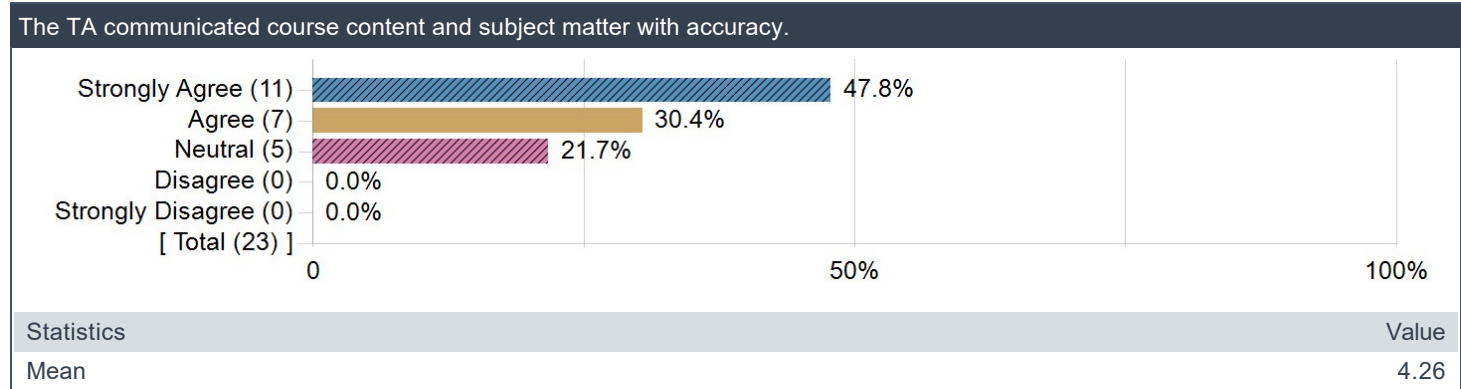


Statistics

Value

Mean

4.17



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of your interactions with your teaching assistant that were most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
I think his PowerPoints for discussions were good at providing real life examples of ethical dilemmas related to what we are learning in class and writing our discussion essays on before actually engaging in discussion.
I felt like Suryansh was a very approachable TA and he was always very patient and thorough with his explanations. In discussions, he always gave a clear explanation of the subject we were learning and used many real-life examples that made the topic more relatable.
He maintained a consistent structure of the discussion throughout the entire semester, so there was no confusion on what we were doing in discussion.
he was very helpful answering my questions
His discussions and talking points during discussion section was thoughtful.
Helpful during recitation
The group recitations were well organized and fun.
The recitation sessions
good explanations
He helped me understand course content better when I had questions.
N/a
He explained ethical topics during discussions which helped us gain a deeper understanding of the course content

What is one thing the teaching assistant could do differently to help improve future students' learning in this course?

Comments
I think the discussion should be more student-led. I feel like we didn't get to discuss much as a class and it wasn't as engaging as I thought it should be.
I don't have any discretions regarding Suryansh, I felt like his teaching was concise and very clear.
I think not leading the discussions so strongly would be better for students to have more engaging and longer conversations about the ethics of economics. At times, I felt as though he was talking and not giving us time to think, and when he did ask us for any response, then he would give us maybe 3 seconds to think before he would start talking. But otherwise, I really enjoyed his discussions and understanding how the ethics of economics is a widely discussed topic today.
n/a
I didn't really work with the TA much so I am not sure.
N/A
nothing
Explain more than just the basic concepts in the recitation sections
be more articulate
nothing
N/a
NA